# Buffalo Bills / opponent rulebook

Snapshot October 22, 2026. Games through week 6, last game October 19. Public-data demonstration for weekly preparation.

| Situation / outcome | All matching | Discovery | Check |
|---|---|---|---|
| Third-and-long five-plus rush<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 11/35<br>6 games | 9/25 | 2/10 |
| Third-down blitzers<br>At least one charted blitzer | 18/62<br>6 games | 11/39 | 7/23 |
| Early-down five-plus rush<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 74/194<br>6 games | 43/122 | 31/72 |
| Five-plus rush against motion<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 69/183<br>6 games | 34/106 | 35/77 |
| Five-plus rush against shotgun<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 39/181<br>6 games | 26/119 | 13/62 |
| First-down loaded box<br>Seven-plus box | 114/184<br>6 games | 75/118 | 39/66 |
| Five-plus rush in the red zone<br>Five-plus actual rushers | 17/44<br>6 games | 9/26 | 8/18 |

## Original held-out check: lower Brier is better

Five-plus actual rushers: 96 plays, 2 games. Model 0.2448; base rate 0.2433. GREY: no demonstrated improvement over base rate.
At least one charted blitzer: 96 plays, 2 games. Model 0.2448; base rate 0.2433. GREY: no demonstrated improvement over base rate.
Seven-plus box: 139 plays, 2 games. Model 0.1957; base rate 0.2497. Lower Brier on this small check; experimental.

## Interpretation and limits

Discovery uses weeks 1-4; check uses complete games in weeks 5-6. The policy was fixed before that original check. The next-game estimator now uses all snapshot rows. This is development evidence, with no fresh validation. Rule frequencies do not have independent rule-level predictive validation. Current coverage, safety shell, named rushers, personnel effects, split-formation effects, and concept success are unavailable. Five-plus actual rush is not a quarterback-pressure event. Rehearsal ideas are coaching hypotheses, with no measured concept advantage.

FTN Data via nflverse, with nflfastR/nflverse play-by-play. Adaptations: filtered rows, joins, flags, and summaries. This rulebook and the demo adaptation are CC BY-SA 4.0. Retain attribution and reuse rights. PBP is CC BY 4.0. No BDB or proprietary feed is included.
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